

# Djokovic Comes Back to Win in Beijing

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Novak Djokovic had a tough match at the China Open in Beijing. He lost the first **set** to China's Bu Yunchaokete. Then he came back to win 4-6, 7-6, 6-2. The match lasted two hours and 52 minutes.

Djokovic is 39 years old. He has won the China Open six times. He has won all 31 matches he has played in Beijing.

In the second **set**, Djokovic needed a medical timeout. He also spoke with a trainer. He went on to win the **tie-break** 7-2. Then he won four games in a row in the final **set**. He finished with a **backhand** winner.

Next, Djokovic will play either Alexander Zverev or Shang Juncheng for a place in the quarter-finals.

In the women's event, Aryna Sabalenka won her first match. She beat Renata Zarazua 6-1, 6-3. Sabalenka hit 11 **aces**. The match took 63 minutes.

Sabalenka is the world number two. She said expecting more from herself can help her improve, but it can also use up her energy. She is trying to be easier on herself.

Sabalenka will play Nikola Bartunkova next. Bartunkova is a 20-year-old from the Czech Republic. She came close to beating Sabalenka at the Berlin Open in June.

In other matches, Mirra Andreeva beat Yuan Yue. Daniil Medvedev also won. British **doubles** pair Julian Cash and Lloyd Glasspool won their match too.

## Word Treasure

**set** -- A part of a tennis match made up of games.

**tie-break** -- A special scoring game used to decide a tied set.

**backhand** -- A tennis stroke made with the back of the hitting hand facing forward.

**aces** -- Serves that win points without the other player touching the ball.

**doubles** -- Tennis played by two teams of two players.

## Background you need

Tennis matches are divided into sets, and sets are divided into games.  
In doubles, two players work together on each side of the court.

## Break it down

The opening gives Djokovic's opponent, result and match length.  
The next paragraphs describe his Beijing record and comeback.  
The article then covers Sabalenka's win and comments about herself.  
The ending names her next opponent and gives other results.

## Why it matters

The matches show how players can recover after a difficult start. Sabalenka's comments also describe how high expectations can both help a player and use up energy.

## Test what you remember

### 1. Who did Djokovic beat in this match?

- ☐ (A) Alexander Zverev
- ☐ (B) Bu Yunchaokete
- ☐ (C) Daniil Medvedev
- ☐ (D) Shang Juncheng

### 2. How long did Djokovic's match last?

- ☐ (A) One hour and 12 minutes
- ☐ (B) Two hours and 12 minutes
- ☐ (C) Two hours and 52 minutes
- ☐ (D) One hour and 52 minutes

### 3. What happened to Djokovic in the first set?

- ☐ (A) He won the set.
- ☐ (B) He took a timeout.
- ☐ (C) He won a tie-break.
- ☐ (D) He lost the set.

### 4. How many aces did Sabalenka hit?

- ☐ (A) Three aces
- ☐ (B) Twelve aces
- ☐ (C) Six aces
- ☐ (D) Eleven aces

### 5. What did Sabalenka say about expecting more from herself?

- ☐ (A) It helps her predict the final score.
- ☐ (B) It always makes matches feel easier.
- ☐ (C) It can help but also use up energy.
- ☐ (D) It means she no longer needs practice.

### 6. Who will Sabalenka play next?

- ☐ (A) Mirra Andreeva
- ☐ (B) Renata Zarazua
- ☐ (C) Nikola Bartunkova
- ☐ (D) Yuan Yue

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: C 3: D 4: D 5: C 6: C

## Questions to think about

**1. Aryna Sabalenka: She said expecting more from herself can help her move forward but can also drain her energy. She is trying to be easier on herself.**

**MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):**